

Problem 1: miks salat

(20 marks)

Below is a salad of words and short phrases in Naijá¹ (Nigerian Pidgin English) and their counterparts in Tok Pisin² (Papua New Guinea Pidgin English). However, the salad bowl fell off the table, and now everything is somehow even more mixed up.

Naijá/Tok Pisin

1	kis	10	small pikin	19	pikinini man
2	man pikin	11	bad belle	20	tingting paul
3	skata brain	12	eye glass	21	liklik kaikai
4	gat bel	13	carry belle	22	hau bodi
5	yu stap gut	14	liklik pikinini	23	chop maut
6	hamas	15	lusim tingting	24	kolim bel
7	kul tempa	16	hau moch	25	bel nogut
8	windo bilong fes	17	small chop	26	chop bullet
9	em kisim sut	18	komot mind		

English

27	get (a) shot/injection	32	confused	37	spectacles
28	baby	33	pacify/calm down	38	son
29	appetizers	34	forget	39	pregnant
30	hateful	35	kiss (<i>noun</i>)		
31	how are you?	36	how much (money)?		

¹Naijá, also known as Nigerian Pidgin, is an English-based creole spoken throughout Nigeria. It developed during the 17th and 18th centuries, when West Africans and English traders/colonies needed a common means of communication. Over time, it grew into a vibrant everyday language with millions of speakers, its own slang, and a lively media presence. Naijá combines English vocabulary with patterns and expressions from various Nigerian languages: Yoruba, Igbo, Edo, Hausa, and others, giving it a distinctive rhythm and flavour.

²Despite being half a world away, Tok Pisin emerged from a similar history and thus shares similarities with Naijá. It developed in the 1800s in the Pacific, when people from many different islands worked together on plantations and needed a shared language. Like Naijá, Tok Pisin is primarily based on English words. Still, its grammar and expressions are derived from the numerous local languages of Papua New Guinea. Today, it is one of the country's official languages and is spoken by millions of people.

Assignment 1 (14 marks)

Your first task is to determine which ones belong together and then match each pair to its corresponding English meaning (answer in index triples, arranged in the order Naijá-Tok Pisin-English, e.g. if you think “**101. miks**” is a Naijá word that corresponds to “**213. salat**” that is a Tok Pisin word and both mean “**72. mess**” in English, then your answer would be **101-213-72**).

Hint: Both Naijá and Tok Pisin evolved from English contact in multilingual communities; they often resemble distant cousins, sharing simple spellings, short compound words, and a love of expressive metaphors, particularly those involving body parts. At the same time, each language has its own personality and its own way of building meanings.

Assignment 2 (6 marks)

Translate the following:

- (a) **get** (English → Tok Pisin)
- (b) **chop knuckle** (Naijá → English)
- (c) **gras bilong ai** (Tok Pisin → English)

– Mukund Choudhary
